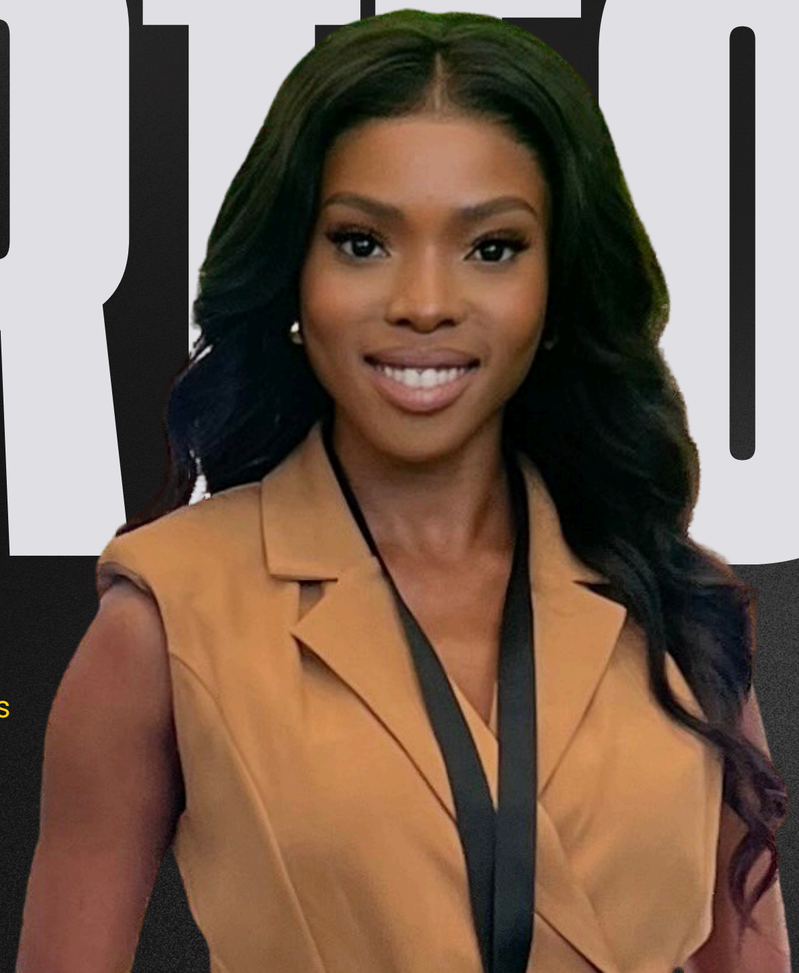
Big Brand THEORY

PAID MEDIA

PORTFOLIO



Helping businesses build scalable customer acquisition systems through Meta and Google Ads

WELCOME!

FREELANCE PAID MEDIA SPECIALIST

Hi! I'm Chanel Xaba, a Paid Media Specialist with 7.5 years' experience, including 5 years in agency environments such as Ogilvy and 2.5 years in independent consulting. I help businesses build scalable customer acquisition systems through paid media.
I've independently managed lead generation and e-commerce accounts across South Africa, the US and UK, spanning multiple industries.

CORE EXPERTISE

- Conversion Tracking: Meta CAPI, Google Analytics, Google Tag Manager and offline conversion integration
- Paid Media Strategy
- Campaign Management: Meta Ads, Google Ads and programmatic platforms (DV360 and CM360)

QUICK WINS FRAMEWORK

An initial performance audit covering tracking, budget allocation, creative, offers, messaging and CRO recommendations to identify and implement early optimisations.

PERSONA-BASED CREATIVE FRAMEWORK

A creative diversification system mapping macro and micro personas, pain points, funnel stages, angles and creative executions (type, hook and format) to keep messaging relevant without multiplying production costs.

Looking forward to putting all this experience together and adding value to your business!

Chanel Xaba



WORK EXPERIENCE

TOTAL SPEND MANAGED: $1.5M+

TOTAL INDUSTRIES: 35+

-39% CPL IN ONE MONTH

+105% INCREASE IN AOV

+25% PURCHASES
Through CRO optimisation recommendations

3X ROAS ON NEW AUDIENCES

ZOE

AHIP
America's Health Insurance Plans

UMASS GLOBAL

kena health

eleanor health

BAIN'S WHISKY

MSC CRUISES

KINTO

STEERS

COTY
SINCE 1904

famous brands
you're in good company

rae & associates

DEBONAIRS PIZZA

MULTICHOICE
ENRICHING LIVES

Africrest
PROPERTIES

LEAD GENERATION

CASE STUDIES

OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

An **online university** for working adults wanted to increase leads for its Psychology, Social Work and Educationprogrammes while reducing cost per lead without increasing media spend.

Diagnosis

A review of the previous three months of campaign performance identified two opportunities for improvement:

- **Audience performance:** The 18–24 age group was consistently underperforming.
- **Lead form alignment:** A single lead form was used across all three programmes, creating an opportunity to better align each form with its programme.

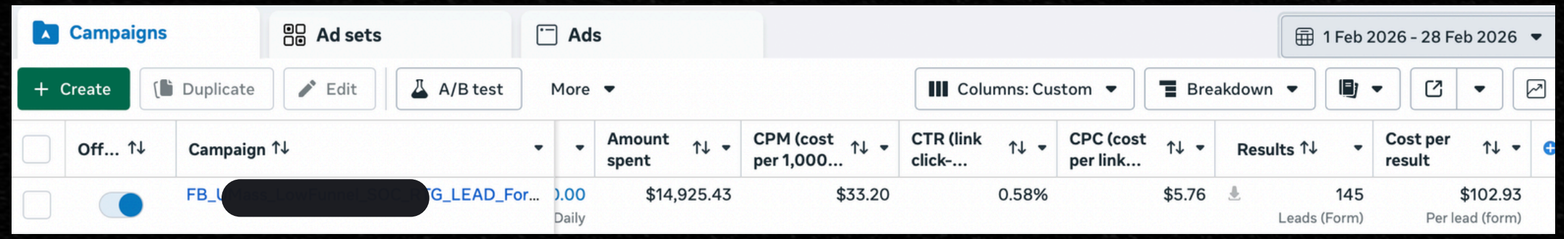
Strategy

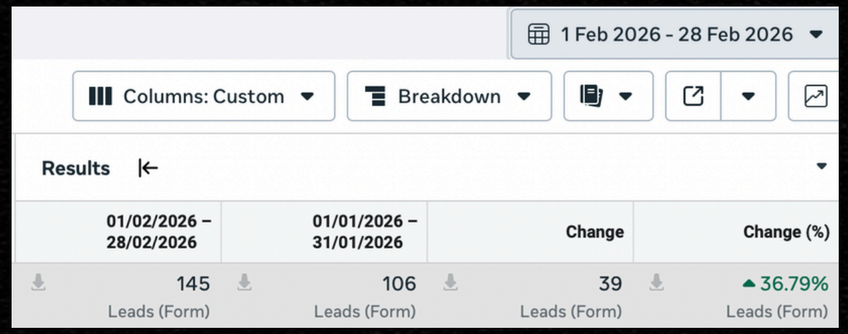
As part of my **Quick Wins framework**:

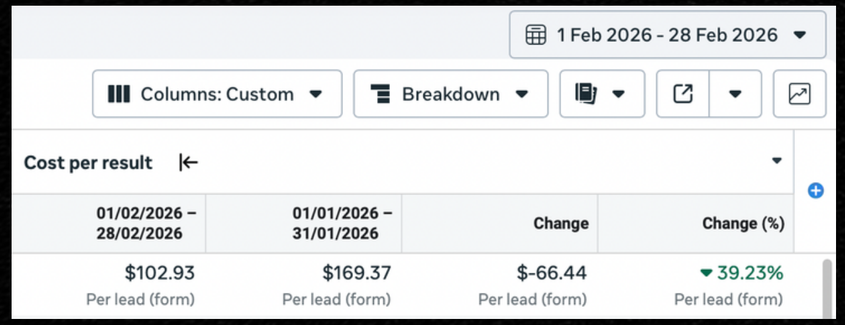
- Excluded the consistently underperforming 18–24 age group.
- Paused the weakest-performing creatives.
- Tested separate lead forms for each programme to improve ad-to-form alignment.
- Implemented other high-impact optimisations identified during the audit.



RESULTS









Results

Following a performance audit of the previous three months, I implemented optimisations to address gaps in audience performance and lead generation.

- **Lead Form Alignment:** Replaced the single form used across all programmes with separate lead forms to improve ad-to-form alignment and maintain consistent messaging through to submission.
- **Audience Efficiency:** Paused the underperforming 18–24 age group to reduce wasted spend.
- **Creative Optimisation:** Paused the weakest-performing creatives.

↑ 36.79% Leads

↓ 39.23% CPL

Leads increased by 37% and CPL decreased by 39% in 1 month.

META ADS - LEAD GENERATION CAMPAIGN

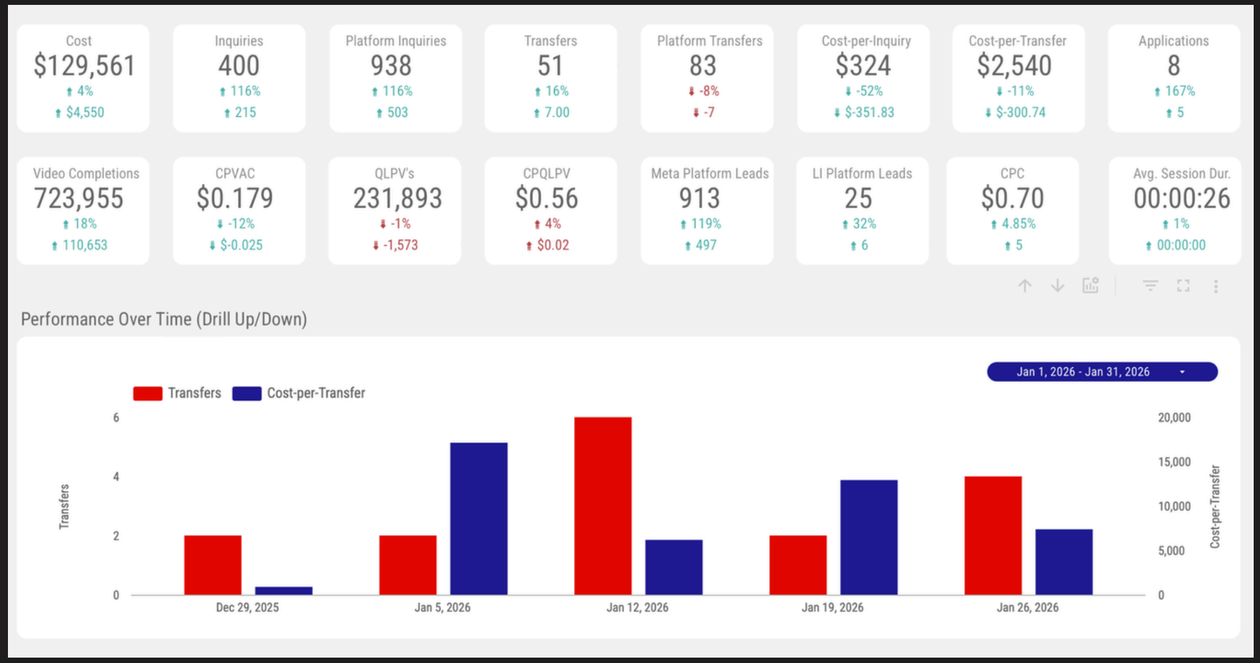
FROM LEAD GENERATION TO BUSINESS OUTCOMES

↑ 119% YoY

- **400 inquiries ↑ 116%**
- **51 transfers ↑ 16%**
- **8 applications ↑ 167%**
- **Cost per inquiry ↓ 52% to $324**
- **Cost per transfer ↓ 11% to $2,540**

Downstream metrics reflect combined campaign performance across paid social channels (Meta and LinkedIn).

Meta generated substantially more platform leads, while overall downstream outcomes also improved.



OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

An **accounting services** client wanted to generate more qualified leads for its bookkeeping, accounting and payroll services through Google Ads, improving lead quality while making better use of the existing budget.

Diagnosis

Leads were captured through Google Forms and stored in Google Sheets, making lead management and reporting increasingly difficult as the business grew.

Strategy

- Implemented conversion tracking for submitted lead forms across each service.
- Expanded the keyword strategy beyond phrase and exact match to include branded keywords, avoiding broad match to limit wasted spend.
- Recommended a CRM to improve lead management and reporting.
- Refined the lead form to improve lead quality.

RESULTS

331 CLICKS	3.26% CTR
3.24% CONVERSION RATE	R688.18 COST/CONV
11 CONVERSIONS	

Campaign	Impr.	Clicks	Avg. CPC	CTR	Cost	Conv. rate	Conversions	Cost / conv.
[redacted]	10,398	339	ZAR22.33	3.26%	ZAR7,570.01	3.24%	11.00	ZAR688.18
Total: Campaigns in your current view	10,398	339	ZAR22.33	3.26%	ZAR7,570.01	3.24%	11.00	ZAR688.18
Total: Campaign	10,398	339	ZAR22.33	3.26%	ZAR7,570.01	3.24%	11.00	ZAR688.18

OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

A **US-based healthcare client** wanted to increase qualified leads while reducing the cost per booked member without increasing media spend.

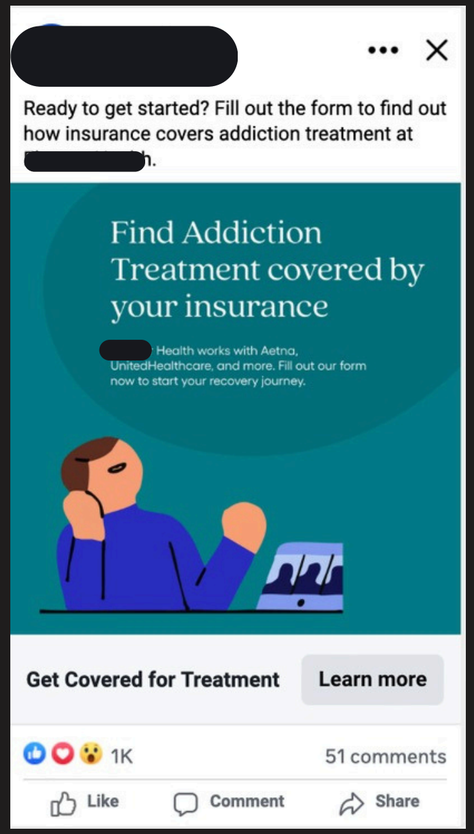
Diagnosis

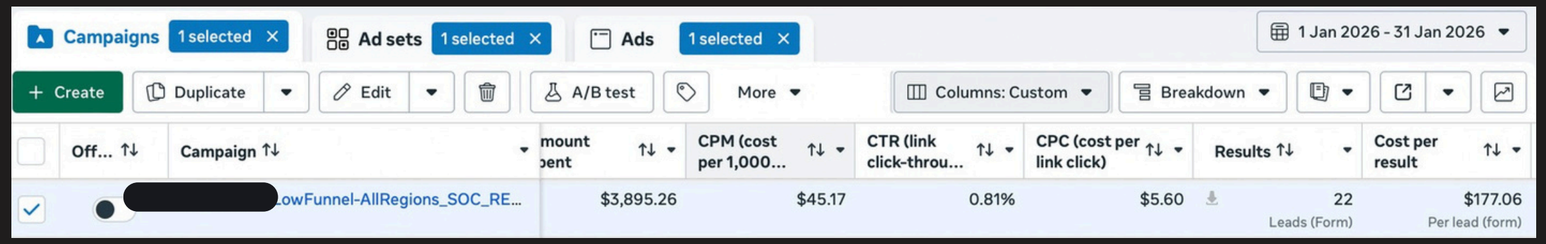
A performance audit identified several immediate optimisation opportunities to improve campaign efficiency without requiring additional budget.

Strategy

As part of my onboarding process, I implement a series of Quick Wins: high-impact optimisations designed to deliver measurable improvements early in the engagement.

- **Audience Optimisation:** Reallocated budget from underperforming age groups to higher-converting audiences.
- **Remarketing Audiences:** Introduced Google Display remarketing audiences into Meta to strengthen Meta's behavioural signals and help the algorithm identify higher-intent users.
- **Creative Testing:** Implemented a structured creative testing framework, with insurance-focused messaging significantly outperforming alternative messaging.





22
LEADS

$177.06
CPL

E-COMMERCE

CASE STUDIES

OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

A **global cruise line** wanted to drive high-intent cruise bookings through Google Ads while maintaining cost efficiency and improving ROAS.

Diagnosis

Not all conversions represented the same level of booking intent, creating an opportunity to improve traffic quality and focus spend on higher-intent users.

Strategy

- **Search Query Optimisation:** Refined search targeting using high-performing queries and automated negative keyword optimisation.
- **Conversion Quality:** Excluded low-intent instant-form drop-offs.
- **Ad Relevance:** Aligned keywords, ad copy and site extensions with search intent and key offers.
- **Budget & Impression Share:** Used impression share and lost impression share due to budget and rank to guide optimisation decisions.

Results

PPC delivered **957 bookings** across exact and phrase match campaigns while maintaining an effecient cost per conversion:

- **Exact match** delivered 548 bookings at R120.23 CPA.
- **Phrase match** delivered 409 bookings at R139.85 CPA.



Campaign	Cost	Avg. CPC	Cost / conv.	Bookings total	Conv. value	Search lost IS (budget)	Search lost IS (rank)	Bid strategy type
[redacted]y-Perf-Max	ZAR5,539.13	ZAR0.33	ZAR4.29	38.20	815,178.00	–	–	Maximize conversions (Target CPA)
[redacted]C-Exact	ZAR65,898.63	ZAR0.94	ZAR120.23	548.09	8,252,229.3	20.95%	2.36%	Target ROAS
[redacted]-Phrase	ZAR56,021.42	ZAR1.13	ZAR136.85	409.37	6,668,020.4	13.53%	34.45%	Target ROAS

OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

A **traditional health and wellness client** wanted to increase revenue from Meta campaigns while maintaining profitable customer acquisition.

Diagnosis

Customers were purchasing, but there was an opportunity to increase revenue by improving Average Order Value (AOV) and aligning spend with periods of higher purchase intent.

Strategy

- **Offer Optimisation:** Owned the creative strategy promoting product bundles and combo offers to increase AOV.
- **Budget Optimisation:** Increased budget during periods of higher demand.
- **Social Proof:** Incorporated customer reviews into the creative strategy to reduce friction in the purchase journey.

RESULTS

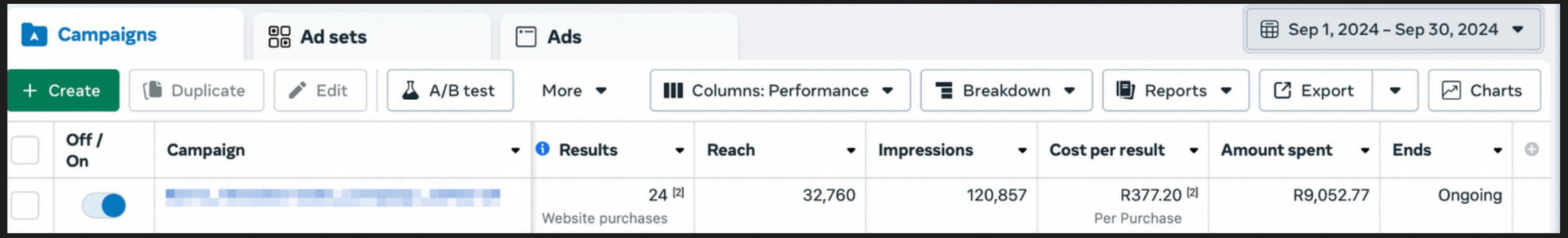
24
PURCHASES

3.24%
CONV RATE

R377.20
CPA

R450 (↑ 105%)
AOV





PROGRAMMATIC ADS

CASE STUDIES

CREATIVE BRIEF - PROGRAMMATIC DISPLAY CAMPAIGN

OBJECTIVE | DIAGNOSIS | STRATEGY | RESULTS

Objective

A **South African digital healthcare startup** wanted to increase app installs through Display & Video 360 (DV360) while maintaining efficient media spend.

Diagnosis

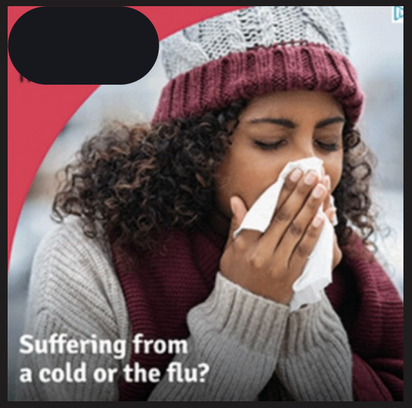
Campaign performance required ongoing optimisation to improve inventory quality, reduce invalid traffic and maximise app install performance.

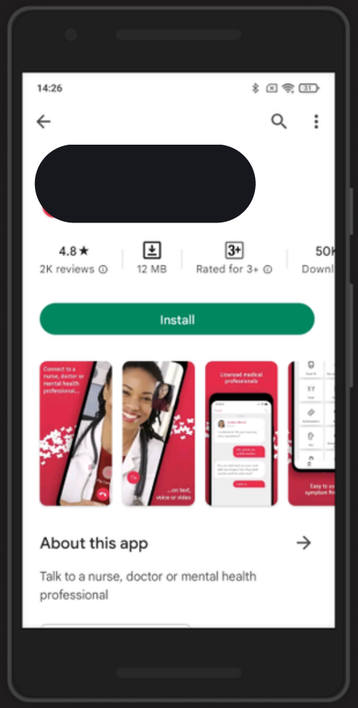
Strategy

- **App Install Optimisation:** Optimised DV360 campaigns towards app installs.
- **Inventory Quality:** Reviewed inventory quality and placement performance to prioritise relevant publishers while minimising invalid traffic.
- **Budget Pacing:** Monitored and optimised budget pacing to ensure spend was delivered evenly throughout the campaign while maintaining performance.
- **Performance Optimisation:** Continuously monitored campaign performance and implemented data-driven optimisations to improve efficiency.

RESULTS

31,283 CLICKS	R12.52 CPM	3,245 APP INSTALLS
R68.45 COST/INSTALL	R2.80 CPC	





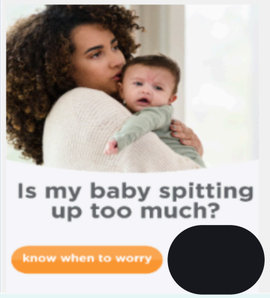
CREATIVE AND COPY

PAID MEDIA

PAID MEDIA CREATIVE AND COPY - META CAMPAIGNS

AD CREATIVE | AD COPY | AD SPECS

STATIC IMAGE 1

Ad Settings	Ad Reference	Worry		*THIS SECTION IS TO BE COMPLETED BY THE CLIENT
	Delivered Ad Size:	2048x2048 and 1080x1920		
	Delivered Safe Zones Sizes:			
	LP / UTM:	[redacted]		
	Goal:	Traffic		*THIS SECTION IS TO BE COMPLETED BY THE MEDIA TEAM AFTER IMPLEMENTATION
	Audience:	Prospecting, Lookalike		
	Placements:	Manual Placements		
	Safe Zones Respected:	YES		
	Status:	IMPLEMENTED		
	QA:	PENDING		
Primary Texts	Frequent spit up? Fussy feeds? Learn the signs that mean it might be more than typical reflux in your baby.	108	Up to 5 / Max no truncation: 125 / Recommended: 120 or less	*THIS SECTION IS TO BE COMPLETED BY THE CLIENT
	Here is what every parent should know about reflux and when to check in with the doctor.	88	Up to 5 / Max no truncation: 125 / Recommended: 120 or less	
	Worried about your baby's spit up? Learn what's normal, and what's not - with guidance from pediatric experts.	111	Up to 5 / Max no truncation: 125 / Recommended: 120 or less	
Creative	IMAGE / GIF / VIDEO		IMAGE REFERENCE	
	Creative Link:	[redacted]		
Headlines	Worried about spit up?	22	Up to 5 brief headlines / Recommended: Max 35 characters / Headlines won't appear in all placements	
	[redacted] - Trusted by Parents	47	Up to 5 brief headlines / Recommended: Max 35 characters / Headlines won't appear in all placements	
	Spit Up: Normal or a Sign to call the Doctor?	45	Up to 5 brief headlines / Recommended: Max 35 characters / Headlines won't appear in all placements	
	What spit up could be telling you	33	Up to 5 brief headlines / Recommended: Max 35 characters / Headlines won't appear in all placements	
Descriptions	Know what's normal and when it's time to check in with the doctor.	66	Up to 5 descriptions Max no truncation: 30 / Reccomended: 40 or less	
CTA	CTA	Learn More		

Creative management & QA system

I developed a centralised creative management and QA document to track client-delivered assets, draft ad copy, creative specifications, safe zone compliance and final QA.

It gives the clients visibility into live ad placements through screenshot and links to final creative assets.

LET'S WORK TOGETHER



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Social Media

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